



diagram - Bagua most - Yin/Yang & the Eight Trigrams

The Eight Principles (Bā Gāng) share their root with the Bagua (八卦) — the Eight Trigrams of the Yijing, arranged here around the Taijitu (Yin/Yang symbol). Both frameworks organize the world into paired, dynamically balanced opposites.

🌟 Master Differentiation Table

Feature	Exterior 表	Interior 里	Cold 寒	Heat 热	Deficiency 虚	Excess 实
Onset	Sudden	Gradual	Either	Either	Gradual	Sudden or gradual
Complexion	Normal/slight flush	Variable	Pale, white	Red, flushed	Pale, sallow	Bright red or dusky
Fever	Yes + aversion to cold	Fever only (no aversion)	Chills	High fever	Low-grade/tidal	High
Thirst	Mild or none	Yes (Interior Heat)	No / warm drinks	Yes / cold drinks	May be dry mouth	Intense thirst
Urine	Normal	Variable	Clear, copious	Scanty, dark yellow	Clear/frequent	Dark, scanty
Stools	Normal	Variable	Loose, watery	Constipated, dry	Loose	Constipated
Tongue body	Normal	Changes	Pale	Red	Pale or red (Yin def)	Red
Tongue coat	Thin white	Thick/other changes	White, moist	Yellow, dry	Little or none	Thick, sticky
Pulse	Floating 浮	Deep 沉	Slow/Tight	Rapid	Weak/Thready/Fine	Forceful/Full/Wiry
Pain response	—	—	Relieved by warmth	Relieved by cold	Relieved by pressure	Aggravated by pressure
Voice/breath	Normal	Variable	Weak, low	Loud, coarse	Feeble, low	Sonorous, coarse



Critical Exam Distinctions

Full Heat vs Empty Heat: Full = red tongue with THICK YELLOW COAT + rapid FORCEFUL pulse. Empty = red tongue with NO COAT (peeled) + rapid FINE/THREADY pulse. True Heat/False Cold: interior heat so extreme extremities appear cold — DEEP FORCEFUL pulse reveals truth. True Cold/False Heat: extreme cold forces Yang to surface — patient WANTS TO COVER despite flushed face.



🌟 Seven Emotions (七情) — Complete Reference

Emotion	Organ(s)	Effect on Qi	Key Manifestations	Tongue/Pulse Clue
Anger 怒 incl. resentment, frustration, rage, bitterness	Liver	Rises	Headache, dizziness, tinnitus, red face, stiff neck/shoulders. Repressed → LR Qi Stag; expressed → LR Yang rising; with KI Yin def → LR Yang rising; with Heat → LR Fire	Tongue: red, red sides, yellow coat (Fire). Pulse: Wiry (必须!) If not Wiry, it is NOT anger.
Joy 喜 = overstimulation, excessive excitement, craving	Heart	Slows	Palpitations, insomnia, restlessness, overexcitability, talking a lot. Sudden joy = akin to shock. Leads to Heart Fire or Heart Empty-Heat.	Tongue: red tip. Pulse: slow, slightly overflowing but empty (left Front position)
Sadness/Grief 悲 incl. regret, grief, mourning	Lungs & Heart	Dissolves	Breathlessness, tiredness, chest discomfort, depression, crying. Long-term → Lung Yin def (night sweats, FE pulse, no coat). Can also affect Liver (Ethereal Soul/Hun — aimlessness, confusion)	Tongue: normal early; peeled coat late (Yin def). Pulse: weak Front positions, no "wave," doesn't flow toward thumb
Worry 忧 most common emotional cause in Western society	Lungs & Spleen	Knots	Lungs: shallow breathing, tense shoulders, dry cough, weak voice, pale. Spleen: poor appetite, epigastric discomfort, abdominal distension, tiredness. Also affects Heart → palpitations, chest tightness, insomnia	Tongue: normal or pale. Pulse: right Front slightly tight or Wiry (Lungs); right Middle tight but Weak (Spleen)
Pensiveness 思 brooding, nostalgia, obsessive thinking, excessive mental work	Spleen	Knots	Similar to worry. Poor appetite, epigastric discomfort, abdominal distension, tiredness, pale complexion. Also: palpitations, chest tightness, insomnia (Heart qi stagnation)	Tongue: pale. Pulse: right Middle tight; no "wave" ONLY on right Middle (sadness = no wave in Front AND Middle)

Emotion	Organ(s)	Effect on Qi	Key Manifestations	Tongue/Pulse Clue
 Fear 恐 chronic anxiety, chronic fear, insecurity	Kidneys	Descends	Children: nocturnal enuresis. Adults: incontinence, diarrhea after sudden fright. Chronic: KI Yin def → Empty-Heat of Heart: palpitations, insomnia, night sweating, dry mouth, malar flush. LR Blood def and GB def also cause fearfulness.	Tongue: normal (acute) → red, little coat (chronic KI Yin def). Pulse: thready rapid (Yin def type)
 Shock 惊 sudden fright; even sudden good news can cause shock	Heart (& Kidneys)	Scatters	Sudden depletion of Heart Qi, Heart becomes "smaller." Palpitations, breathlessness, insomnia. Bluish tinge on forehead. Heart pulse Tight and Fine. Strong Heart → Qi descends. Weak Heart → Qi rises (Empty-Heat symptoms)	Tongue: pale or slightly red tip. Pulse: Moving (短动脉) — short, slippery, bean-shaped, rapid, vibrating sensation



All Emotions Affect the Heart — The Key Clinical Principle

The Heart houses the Mind (Shen) and is the only organ that can recognize and feel emotional tension. Therefore all 7 emotions affect the Heart in addition to their primary organ. This is why red tongue TIP is commonly seen in any emotional problem regardless of which organ is primarily involved.

✨ Six Excesses (六淫) — Rapid Reference

Factor	Season	Nature/Character	Key Clinical Signs	Related Organ
Wind 风	Spring	Yang, mobile, sudden, migratory, opens pores. "Chief of 100 diseases."	Sudden onset, rapidly changing, migratory pain, aversion to wind, sweating, Floating pulse	Liver
Cold 寒	Winter	Yin, contracts, causes severe pain, watery discharge	Severe chills, no sweat, intense fixed pain worse with cold, white moist coat, Tight pulse	Kidneys
Summer-Heat 暑	Summer ONLY	Yang, rises, injures Qi and Yin simultaneously	High fever, profuse sweating, severe thirst, dark urine, fatigue, Floating Rapid pulse	Heart
Dampness 湿	Late Summer	Yin, heavy, turbid, sticky, lingers, gradual	Body/limb heaviness, turbid discharges, fullness chest/epigastrium, greasy tongue coat, Soggy pulse	Spleen
Dryness 燥	Autumn	Injures Body Fluids and Yin	Dry mouth/nose/throat/skin /stools, dry cough with little sputum, dry tongue	Lungs

Factor	Season	Nature/Character	Key Clinical Signs	Related Organ
Fire/Heat 火	Summer (+ endogenous)	Yang, rises, injures Yin and Blood, harasses Mind	High fever, aversion to heat, thirst, dark urine, restlessness, red tongue yellow coat, Rapid Overflowing pulse	Heart

Five Exhaustions (五劳) — Exam Classic

- **Excessive eye use** → injures Blood → Heart
- **Excessive lying down** → injures Qi → Lungs
- **Excessive sitting** → injures muscles → Spleen
- **Excessive standing** → injures bones → Kidneys
- **Excessive exercise** → injures sinews → Liver

Source: Simple Questions Ch.23

Drug Effects on Tongue & Pulse — Clinical Pearl

- **Beta-blockers** → slow, deep pulse — do NOT use for diagnosis
- **Tranquilizers** → "sluggish, reluctant" pulse — not in 29 qualities
- **Antibiotics** → peeled tongue in patches = Stomach-Yin def
- **Oral steroids** → swollen red tongue
- **Cannabis (long-term)** → Kidney def, weak Zhi (will-power)



EAM310 • Internal, External & Miscellaneous

Causes

FCM Ch.20–22 • Maciocia's Three-Category Aetiology Framework

Week 2 • Jon Centeno • VUIM

✨ The Three Categories of Disease Causation (Maciocia)

Ch.20 — Internal Causes

The Seven Emotions in clinical depth: when an emotion becomes pathological, the Body-Mind reciprocal relationship, and the "Five Emotions Turn Into Fire" principle.

Ch.21 — External Causes

The Six Excesses in clinical depth: when climate becomes pathological, Shang Han vs Wen Bing schools, and Aversion to Cold vs Yang-Deficiency Cold.

Ch.22 — Miscellaneous Causes

Constitution, Overwork, Diet, Sexual Activity, Trauma, and Drugs (medicinal and recreational) — causes that don't fit neatly into "emotional" or "climatic" categories.

😞 When Does an Emotion Become a Cause of Disease? (Ch.20)

(1) Long-lasting — months or years, OR (2) Very intense, even if brief. Shock is the exception — can cause disease almost instantly due to its sheer intensity. Normal emotions in normal circumstances do NOT cause disease.

☀️ When Does Climate Become Pathological? (Ch.21)

Only when there is a relative imbalance between the body's Qi and the climatic factor — either the climate is excessive/unseasonal, OR the body's Qi is relatively weak at that moment. Even a healthy person can be attacked if the pathogen is strong enough.

✨ Two Historical Schools of Exterior Disease (Ch.21)

School	Founder	Focus	Framework
Shang Han 伤寒	Zhang Zhong Jing (AD 150–219)	Wind-Cold invasions	Six Stages (Taiyang → Jueyin)
Wen Bing 温病	Wu You Ke, Ye Tian Shi, Wu Ju Tong (Ming-Qing)	Wind-Heat, febrile/infectious disease	Four Levels (Wei/Qi/Ying/Xue); Ye Tian Shi also formed Three Burners theory

✨ Exterior Aversion to Cold vs Yang-Deficiency Cold

Feature	Exterior Aversion to Cold	Yang Deficiency Cold
Onset	Sudden	Chronic, gradual
Relieved by covering?	NO (hallmark)	YES
Accompanying fever?	Yes, simultaneous	No
Pulse	Floating	Deep, weak

Cause	Key Points
Constitution	Determined by parents' Kidney Essence at conception + mother's health in pregnancy. ~50% of lifetime health per Maciocia. Strong: broad forehead, long nose, full cheeks, firm muscles. Weak: narrow forehead, small nose, flabby muscles.
Overwork	NOT physical labor — working long hours for YEARS. Short-term → Qi deficiency (recovers in days). Years of overwork → Yin deficiency (esp. Kidney-Yin). Mental overwork → Spleen weakness (concentration/memory).
Diet	Insufficient → Qi/Blood deficiency. Overeating → Dampness/Phlegm. Cold/raw foods → weakens Spleen-Yang. Sweet foods → major Phlegm cause in Western diet. Hot/spicy → interior Heat/Fire. Greasy → Dampness.
Drugs (medicinal)	Beta-blockers: slow deep pulse (unusable for dx). Tranquilizers: "sluggish/reluctant" pulse. Antibiotics: peeled tongue patches (Stomach-Yin def). Oral steroids: swollen red tongue.
Drugs (recreational)	Cannabis: Kidney def, weak Will/Zhi. Cocaine: Phlegm-Fire in Heart (long-term). LSD: Heart-Fire. Ecstasy: weakens Kidneys, obstructs Heart orifices.



The Five Exhaustions (Simple Questions Ch.23) — classic exam material

Excessive use of eyes injures Blood (Heart). Excessive lying down injures Qi (Lungs). Excessive sitting injures muscles (Spleen). Excessive standing injures bones (Kidneys). Excessive exercise injures sinews (Liver).



EAM310 • Diagnostic Worksheet A

Eight Principles • Pattern Identification Practice

Cover answers – test yourself!
Jon Centeno • VUIM • Summer 2026

✨ Section 1: Fill in the Blanks

1. The simultaneous occurrence of _____ and _____ is the hallmark sign of an exterior syndrome.

2. When aversion to cold disappears and the patient throws off blankets, the pathogen has moved to the _____.

3. Full Heat tongue: _____ tongue, _____ coat.
Empty Heat tongue: _____ tongue, _____ coat.

4. Deficiency pain is _____ (better/worse) with pressure.
Excess pain is _____ with pressure.

5. In Collapse of Yin: sweat is _____ and body is _____.
In Collapse of Yang: sweat is _____ and body is _____.

6. Anger makes Qi _____. Joy makes Qi _____.
Sadness _____ Qi. Worry _____ Qi. Fear makes Qi _____.
Shock _____ Qi.

7. If anger is the cause of disease, the pulse MUST be _____.
If the pulse is not _____, anger is not the cause.

8. All 7 emotions also affect the _____ because this organ houses the _____ and is responsible for consciousness.

9. The Five Exhaustions: eyes → _____, lying → _____,
sitting → _____, standing → _____, exercise → _____.

10. Antibiotics cause the tongue to become _____, indicating _____ deficiency. Beta-blockers make the pulse _____ and _____, so it CANNOT be used for diagnosis.

✨ Section 2: Case Analysis – Identify the Pattern

Case A

A 45-year-old woman presents with afternoon fever, malar flush, heat sensations in the palms and soles, night sweating, insomnia, dry mouth and throat, yellow urine, dry stools. Tongue: red, no coating. Pulse: thready, rapid.

Which Eight Principle pattern(s) does this represent?

Is this Full Heat or Empty Heat? What is the key differentiating feature?

Case B

A 32-year-old man has sudden onset of fever, chills (both simultaneously), headache, stiff neck, runny nose, slight cough. He feels cold and wants to be covered. Tongue: thin white coating. Pulse: floating, tight.

Which Eight Principle pattern is this? What two features confirm it is still on the Exterior?

Is this Wind-Cold or Wind-Heat? What features led you to this conclusion?

Case C

A 55-year-old executive presents with constant irritability, headaches (temporal and vertex), dizziness, tinnitus, insomnia, dry eyes, back soreness, anxiety. He reports chronic work stress for 10+ years. Tongue: red, slightly dry, redder sides. Pulse: wiry, somewhat thready.

What emotion is the primary cause of disease? What supports this conclusion?

Name two TCM patterns present and explain why both coexist.

EAM310 • Pulse & Tongue Journal #1

Due Week 2 • 10% of Grade • Daily Practice Template

Jon Centeno • VUIM
EAM310 • Prof. Schrier



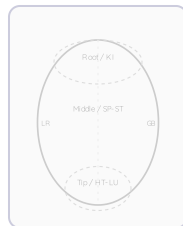
Instructions

Observe your own tongue and pulse daily. Record findings in this template. Note: time of day, recent meals, sleep, emotional state — all affect findings. Practice noticing changes. The goal is developing observational sensitivity, not diagnosing yourself.

Entry # _____

Date: _____ Time: _____ Condition: _____

Tongue Observation



Draw/shade what you observe

Body Color: _____

Coating: _____

Moisture: _____

Shape: _____

Notable features: _____

Pulse Observation

寸 Cun

Left = HT/PC
Right = LU

关 Guan

Left = LR/GB
Right = SP/ST

尺 Chi

Left = KI(Yin)
Right = KI(Yang)

Rate: _____

Depth: _____

Strength: _____

Quality: _____

Width/tension: _____

Overall assessment / pattern hypothesis / notes:

Entry # _____

Date: _____ Time: _____ Condition: _____

Tongue:

Color: _____ Coat: _____

Moisture: _____ Shape: _____

Notable: _____

Pulse:

L Cun: _____ R Cun: _____

L Guan: _____ R Guan: _____

L Chi: _____ R Chi: _____

Assessment:



EAM310 • Qi • Blood • Body Fluid Syndromes

FCM Ch.31 • CAM Ch.10 • Pattern Reference

Week 1 • Jon Centeno • VUIM

✨ Qi Syndromes (气证)

Pattern	Key Features	Tongue	Pulse	Etiology
Qi Deficiency 气虚	Dizziness, blurred vision, lassitude, dislike speaking, spontaneous sweating, worse on exertion, pale face	Pale, white coat	Deficiency type (weak)	Long illness, age, poor diet, overwork
Sinking Qi 气陷 (subtype of Qi def)	All Qi def signs PLUS: bearing-down sensation in abdomen, prolapse (anus, uterus, stomach, kidney), gastroptosis, renal ptosis	Pale	Weak, slowing	Same as Qi def — especially middle energizer
Qi Stagnation 气滞	Distension MORE than pain, waxes and wanes, no fixed location, related to emotions, alleviated by belching/flatus	Normal or slightly purple	Wiry (if Liver)	Emotional upset, diet, trauma, cold invasion
Rebellious Qi 气逆	LUNG: cough, asthma, dyspnea. STOMACH: belching, hiccup, nausea, vomiting. LIVER: headache, dizziness, hemoptysis, coma (severe)	Variable by organ	Variable	External pathogen, food retention, emotional upset, Liver invading

✨ Blood Syndromes (血证)

Pattern	Key Features	Tongue	Pulse	Distinguishing Feature
Blood Deficiency 血虚	Pallor/sallow face, pale lips, dizziness, blurred vision, palpitations, insomnia, poor memory, numbness hands/feet	Pale	Thready, weak	In women: scanty/absent menstruation. Spleen is source — SP deficiency is common root.
Blood Stasis 血瘀	Fixed stabbing pain, mass tumors (firm, fixed), hemorrhage (dark, purplish, clots), ecchymoses, petechiae, purplish skin/tongue spots	Purple body or purplish spots	Thready, hesitant (涩脉)	Pain is FIXED and STABBING. Mass is firm and non-moving. Blood is dark with clots.
Heat in Blood 血热	Mental restlessness, mania (severe), dry mouth (no desire to drink), various bleeding (epistaxis, hemoptysis, hematuria, menorrhagia), skin rashes	Deep red	Rapid	Excessive internal heat → hyperactive blood circulation → forced out of vessels. Heat in blood stirs Mind → restlessness/mania.

✨ Body Fluid Syndromes (津液证)

Insufficiency of Body Fluid 津液不足

- Dry mouth and throat, dry lips, decaying teeth
- Dry, withered skin (no elasticity)
- Scanty urine, constipation
- Dry tongue (little/no moisture)
- Thready, rapid pulse
- **Cause:** Excessive sweating, blood loss, vomiting, diarrhea, heat/dryness pathogen

Retention of Body Fluid 水液停聚

- Phlegm, fluid retention, edema
- Fullness chest/epigastrium/abdomen
- Heaviness, stickiness in mouth
- Absence of thirst, diarrhea
- Sallow complexion, edema of limbs
- **Four types:** Tanyin (stomach-intestines), Xuanyin (hypochondrium), Yiyin (body surface/anasarca), Zhiyin (chest/epigastrium)

✨ Four Levels (Wei/Qi/Ying/Xue) — Quick Reference

Level	Depth	Chief Signs	Tongue	Pulse
Wei (Defense) 卫	Most superficial — Exterior	Fever, mild aversion to wind/cold, headache, slight sweating, cough, sore throat	Red tip/borders, thin white coat	Superficial, rapid
Qi (Energy) 气	Interior — Zang-fu	High fever (no aversion to cold), thirst, restlessness, sweating, yellow urine	Red, yellow coat	Rapid, forceful
Ying (Nutrient) 营	Deep interior — Blood	Worse at night, dry mouth (no desire to drink), restlessness, insomnia, faint skin rashes, delirium	Deep red, little coat	Thready, rapid
Xue (Blood) 血	Deepest — Blood vessels	Mania, delirium, obvious skin rashes, hemorrhage (hematuria, epistaxis, hemoptysis, hematochezia), coma	Dark deep red	Thready, rapid

**Why this page exists**

CAM Ch.10's Zang-Fu section differentiates patterns for all five Yin organs, not just one. This sheet completes the set — Heart, Liver, Spleen, Lung, Kidney — so the chapter is covered front to back.

Heart Syndromes

Syndrome	Key Manifestations	Tongue	Pulse
Heart Qi Deficiency	Palpitation, SOB, lassitude, spontaneous sweating, worse on exertion	Pale, white coat	Thready, weak/irregular
Heart Yang Deficiency	All above + chills, cold limbs, cyanosis lips; extreme: cold sweat, prostration, coma	Pale swollen OR purplish dark	Thready weak/irregular OR fading
Heart Blood Deficiency	Palpitation, insomnia, dream-disturbed sleep, poor memory, pallor, dizziness, numbness hands/feet	Pale	Thready, weak
Heart Yin Deficiency	Blood def signs + mental restlessness, dry mouth, heat palms/soles, tidal fever, night sweats	Red, little coat	Thready, rapid
Heart Blood Stagnation	Palpitation, stabbing cardiac pain radiating to shoulder/arm, cyanosis, cold limbs	Purplish dark/spots	Thready hesitant/irregular
Heart Fire	Mental restlessness, insomnia, flushed face, thirst, mouth/tongue ulceration, dark urine	Red	Rapid
Phlegm Misting Heart	Mental depression, dullness, incoherent speech, sudden collapse, coma, gurgling sputum	White, sticky coat	String-taut, rolling

Liver Syndromes

Syndrome	Key Manifestations	Tongue	Pulse
Liver-Qi Stagnation	Hypochondriac/chest distension or pain (moves), sighing, depression/irritability, premenstrual breast distension, Mei He Qi	Normal, or slightly purple sides	Wiry
Liver-Yang Rising	Dizziness, headache (temporal/vertex), tinnitus, red face, irritability + lower-body deficiency signs	Red, esp. sides	Wiry, possibly Thready-Wiry

Syndrome	Key Manifestations	Tongue	Pulse
Liver-Fire Blazing	Severe throbbing headache, red face/eyes, bitter taste, marked irritability, constipation, dark urine	Red, redder sides, yellow coat	Wiry, rapid, forceful
Liver-Blood Deficiency	Pale face/lips, dizziness, blurred/dry eyes, night blindness, scanty periods, numbness, cramps	Pale, esp. sides	Choppy or Thready
Liver-Wind	Tremor, dizziness, twitching, numbness; severe: collapse, deviated mouth/eye, hemiplegia	Stiff or deviated	Wiry
Cold in Liver Channel	Lower abdominal/genital pain, contracting testicular pain, worse with cold, better with warmth	White, moist coat	Wiry, Tight, Deep

✨ Spleen Syndromes

Syndrome	Key Manifestations	Tongue	Pulse
Spleen-Qi Deficiency	Poor appetite, distension after eating, loose stools, tiredness, sallow complexion	Pale, tooth-marked	Weak / Empty
Spleen-Yang Deficiency	Qi-def signs + cold limbs, cold abdominal pain relieved by warmth, watery discharge, edema	Pale, swollen, wet	Deep, Slow, Weak
Sinking of Spleen-Qi	Bearing-down sensation, chronic diarrhea, prolapse (stomach/uterus/rectum/bladder)	Pale	Weak, slowing
Spleen Not Controlling Blood	Chronic uterine bleeding, blood in stool, easy bruising + Qi-deficiency signs	Pale	Thready, Weak
Cold-Damp Encumbering Spleen	Heaviness, chest/epigastric fullness, poor appetite, nausea, foggy head, no thirst	White, sticky/greasy coat	Soggy or Slow
Damp-Heat in Spleen/Stomach	Fullness, nausea, sticky taste, thirst no desire to drink, possible jaundice	Yellow, greasy coat	Soggy-Rapid / Slippery-Rapid

🎯 Exam Pattern Recognition

Notice the shared logic across all five organs: Qi deficiency = fatigue + weak/empty pulse + pale tongue. Add Yang deficiency = + cold signs + deep/slow pulse. Yin deficiency = + heat-from-deficiency signs (malar flush, night sweats, 5-centre heat) + red tongue no coat + thready rapid pulse. Learn the PATTERN of the pattern, not just five separate organ lists. (Lung & Kidney tables continue on the next sheet.)

✨ Lung Syndromes

Syndrome	Key Manifestations	Tongue	Pulse
Lung-Qi Deficiency	Weak voice, SOB worse on exertion, spontaneous sweating, frequent colds, pale face	Pale	Empty / Weak (R Front)
Lung-Yin Deficiency	Dry cough little/no sputum, dry mouth/throat, malar flush, night sweats, hoarse voice	Red, little coat (front third)	Floating-Empty / Thready-Rapid
Wind-Cold Invading Lung	Aversion to cold, cough, clear thin sputum, no thirst, slight fever	Thin white coat	Floating, Tight
Wind-Heat Invading Lung	Fever predominant, slight aversion to cold, cough, yellow sticky sputum, sore throat, thirst	Thin yellow coat	Floating, Rapid
Phlegm-Damp Obstructing Lung	Cough with copious white sticky sputum, chest fullness, wheezing	White, sticky coat	Slippery
Phlegm-Heat Obstructing Lung	Cough with thick yellow sputum (possibly blood-streaked), fever, thirst, chest pain	Red, yellow sticky coat	Slippery, Rapid

✨ Kidney Syndromes

Syndrome	Key Manifestations	Tongue	Pulse
Kidney-Yang Deficiency	Sore weak lower back/knees, cold limbs, frequent pale urination/nocturia, impotence, edema	Pale, swollen, wet	Deep, Weak (esp. Rear)
Kidney-Yin Deficiency	Sore weak lower back/knees, dizziness, tinnitus, malar flush, night sweats, 5-centre heat	Red, little/no coat	Thready, Rapid
Kidney-Essence Deficiency	Poor memory, slow development (children), premature aging, loose teeth, hair loss	Variable	Deep, Weak (esp. Rear)
Kidney-Qi Not Firm	Frequent/incontinent urination, enuresis, premature ejaculation, leaking discharge, prolapse	Pale	Deep, Weak
Kidney Failing to Receive Qi	Chronic asthma worse on exertion, breathlessness worse on INHALATION, weak low voice	Pale	Deep, Weak/Empty (Rear)
Kidney-Yang Def. + Water Overflow	Severe edema (esp. lower body), abdominal distension, cold limbs, scanty urine	Pale, swollen	Deep, Slow

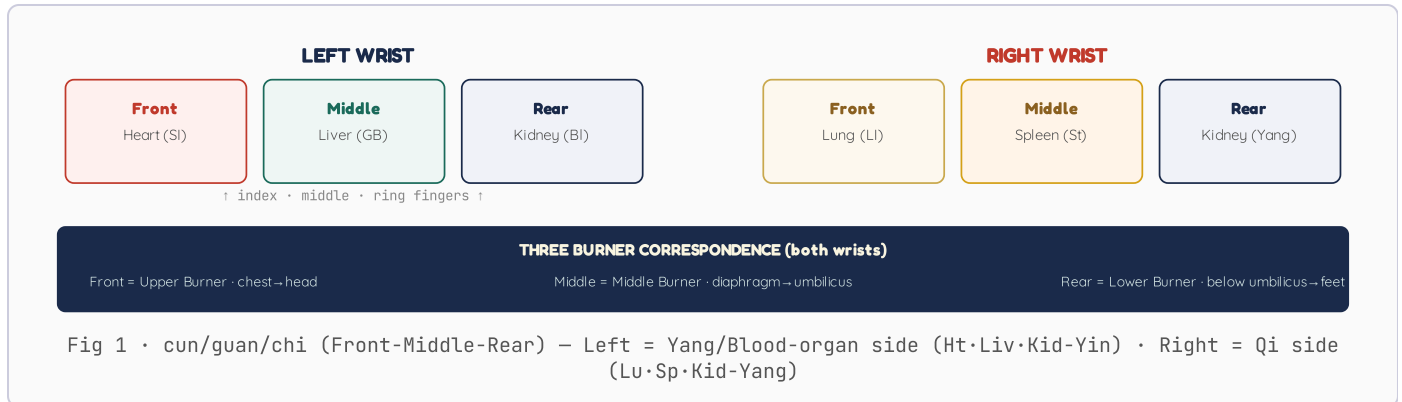


EAM310 • Pulse Diagnosis Master Reference

FCM Ch.25 • CAM Ch.10 • 28 Pulse Qualities + cun/guan/chi

Week 3 • Jon Centeno • VUIM

✨ cun/guan/chi Position Map



🌀 Knotted 结

SLOW + irregular stops
→ Cold + Heart-Yang deficiency

🔥 Hasty 促

RAPID + irregular stops
→ Extreme Heat, Heart-Qi def,
Heart-Fire

⚠️ Intermittent 代

ANY RATE + REGULAR stops
→ Serious Yin-organ problem –
SERIOUS

🌀 Six-Step Pulse Reading Sequence (FCM Box 25.4)

1. Pulse as a whole → 2. Spirit, Stomach-Qi, Root → 3. The 3 levels & 3 positions → 4. Strength of pulse → 5. Overall quality → 6. Individual positions

✨ The 28 Pulse Qualities

#	Quality	Feel	Indicates
1	Floating	Light pressure only	Exterior / Yin def. if Empty at depth
2	Deep	Heavy pressure, near bone	Interior; +Weak=Qi/Yang def; +Full=stasis/Cold/Heat
3	Slow	3 beats/breath	Cold; +Weak=Empty-Cold; +Full=Full-Cold
4	Rapid	5+ beats/breath	Heat; +Full=Full-Heat; +Floating-Empty=Empty-Heat
5	Empty	Big but soft	Qi deficiency
6	Full	Full, hard, long	Full pattern
7	Slippery	Smooth, oily	Phlegm, Dampness, food retention, pregnancy
8	Choppy	Rough, jagged	Blood deficiency, fluid exhaustion
9	Long	Beyond normal position	Heat pattern
10	Short	Less than normal position	Severe Qi def. / Stomach-Qi def.
11	Overflowing	Big, like a flood	Extreme/Full-Heat; +Empty=Empty-Heat

#	Quality	Feel	Indicates
12	Fine	Thinner than normal	Blood deficiency
13	Minute	Extremely thin, hard to feel	Severe Qi + Blood deficiency
14	Tight	Twisted rope	Cold; pain
15	Wiry	Taut guitar string	Liver disharmony, pain, Phlegm
16	Slowed-down	4 beats/breath	HEALTHY — no pathology
17	Hollow	Empty in the middle	Hemorrhage
18	Leather	Hard surface, empty deep	Severe Kidney-Essence/Yin deficiency
19	Firm	Deep + hard + wiry	Blood stasis, interior Cold, pain
20	Soggy	Superficial, very soft	Dampness + Qi def; Yin/Essence def
21	Weak	Deep only, soft	Yang deficiency
22	Scattered	"Broken" into dots	Severe Qi+Blood def, esp. Kidney — SERIOUS
23	Hidden	Beneath the bone	Extreme Yang deficiency
24	Moving	Bean-like, trembling	Shock, anxiety, fright, pain
25	Hasty	Rapid + irregular stops	Extreme Heat, Heart-Qi def, Heart-Fire
26	Knotted	Slow + irregular stops	Cold + Heart-Yang deficiency
27	Intermittent	Regular stops	Serious Yin-organ problem
28	Hurried	Very rapid + agitated	Excess Yang, Fire exhausting Yin



Normal Pulse = 3 Qualities

Stomach-Qi (gentle, calm) + Spirit (soft but strong, regular) + Root (deep level + Rear position clearly felt). A pulse with Spirit but no Root = Yin/Yang organs weak while Qi/Blood still intact.

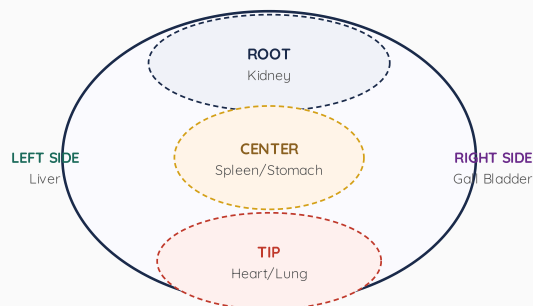


EAM310 • Tongue Diagnosis Master Reference

FCM Ch.23 • Body Color + Shape + Coating

Week 4 • Jon Centeno • VUIM

🌟 Tongue Microsystem Map



5 Pathological Body Colors

- Pale — Blood/Yang deficiency
- Red — Heat
- Deep-Red — severe Heat
- Purple — Blood stasis (always)
- Blue — Interior Cold + stasis

Fig 1 • Heart at tip, Sp/St center, Kidney root, Liver left side, GB right side • 🎀

🔴 Purple Tongue Progression

RED → Reddish-Purple = Heat + Blood Stasis

PALE → Bluish-Purple = Cold + Blood Stasis

Color carries history: purple tongues reveal WHICH prior pattern (Heat or Cold) led to the current stasis.

🟡 Coating Quick Reference

White=Cold (thin white=normal) · Yellow=Heat
(deeper=more severe) · Grey=interior Heat or Cold-Damp ·
Black=extreme Heat or excess Cold

🌟 5 Pathological Body Colors

Color	Indicates
Pale	Yang deficiency (wet) OR Blood deficiency (dry); pale sides = Liver-Blood deficiency
Red	Always Heat. +coating = Full-Heat; no coating = Empty-Heat
Deep-Red	Same as Red, more severe
Purple	Always Blood stasis. Reddish-Purple = from Heat; Bluish-Purple = from Cold
Blue	Same as Bluish-Purple — Interior Cold + Blood stasis

🌟 10 Body Shape Categories

Shape	Indicates
Thin	Blood def. (Pale) or Yin def. (Red, no coat)
Swollen	Dampness or Phlegm
Stiff	Interior Wind or Blood stasis
Flaccid	Deficiency of Body Fluids
Long	Heat, esp. Heart-Heat
Short	Interior Cold (Pale/wet) or extreme Yin def. (Red/peeled)
Cracked	Full-Heat or Yin deficiency ("Heart crack" vs "Stomach crack")

Shape	Indicates
Quivering	Spleen-Qi deficiency
Deviated	Interior Wind
Tooth-marked	Spleen-Qi deficiency



Coating Presence / Root

— Without root (added-on look) = Stomach-Qi deficiency. Partially peeled = Stomach-Yin deficiency. Completely peeled (glossy) = severe Stomach-Yin + Qi exhaustion.



EAM310 • Observation Diagnosis Reference

FCM Ch.23 + CAM Ch.9 • Spirit, Complexion, Eyes, Nose

Week 6 • Jon Centeno • VUIM

✨ Spirit (Shen) Observation

✨ Has Spirit

- Complexion: lustre
- Eyes: lustre, vitality
- Mind: clear, alert
- Breathing: even

👁 Lacks Spirit

- Complexion: dull
- Eyes: dull, clouded
- Mind: unclear, depressed
- Breathing: laboured

Lustre = bright, glowing, "has spirit"

Subtle Reddish Hue = good Mind state

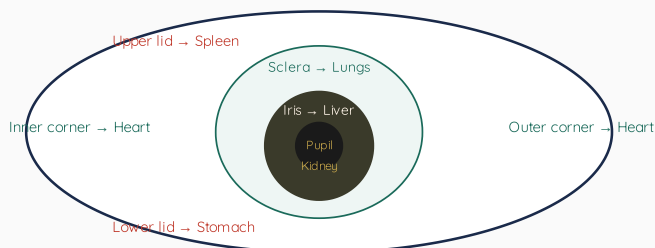
"Contained" Color = veiled by thin white silk

Moisture = skin firm = "has Stomach-Qi"

✨ 6 Pathological Complexion Colors

Color	Key Variants & Meaning
White	Dull-pale=Blood def; Bright-white=Yang def; Bluish-white=Yang def+Cold
Yellow	Sallow=Spleen/Blood def; Bright orange=Damp-Heat (Heat>Damp); Smoky=Damp-Heat (Damp>Heat)
Red	Whole face=Full-Heat; cheekbones only=Empty-Heat
Green	Liver patterns, interior Cold, pain, interior Wind
Blue	Cold, chronic pain; severe = Heart-Yang def + Blood stasis
Black	Moist=Cold; dry/burned=Heat (Kidney-Yin Empty-Heat)

✨ Eye & Nose Zone Maps



Nose

- Tip -> Spleen
- Bridge -> Liver
- Green/blue tip -> Cold in Spleen
- Red bridge -> Liver-Fire

Fig 2 • Eye Zones (FCM Fig 23.15) – corners=Heart, upper lid=Spleen, lower lid=Stomach, sclera=Lungs, iris=Liver, pupil=Kidney



Distinct vs Obscure Complexion

— A "distinct" color = Full or Empty condition with Upright Qi still intact. An "obscure" color = a more serious condition with Upright Qi failing.



EAM310 • Inquiry Reference — 16 Questions

FCM Ch.24 • Pain, Thirst, Sweat, Stools/Urine

Week 7-8 • Jon Centeno • VUIM



Why the order changed

— Maciocia moved Pain to #1 (Western patients' most common complaint) and Chills/Fever to #12, only asked at the end to CONFIRM the Hot/Cold nature of an already-identified pattern. The classical Qing-dynasty 10 questions assumed acute exterior febrile disease (Shang Han Lun bias).

✨ The 16 Questions (Maciocia's Order)

#	Area	#	Area
1	Pain	9	Sleep
2	Food and taste	10	Sweating
3	Stools and urine	11	Ears and eyes
4	Thirst and drink	12	Cold, heat, fever
5	Energy levels	13	Emotional symptoms
6	Head, face, body	14	Sexual symptoms
7	Chest and abdomen	15	Women's symptoms
8	Limbs	16	Children's symptoms

✨ The 16 Questions — What to Actually Ask

#	Category	Example Questions to Ask
1	Pain	"Where exactly? Dull, sharp, burning, stabbing? Constant or comes and goes? Better/worse with pressure, heat, cold, rest, movement?"
2	Food/taste	"Appetite? Any taste in your mouth — bitter, sweet, sour? Cravings? Better/worse after eating?"
3	Stools/urine	"How often, and consistency? Straining or urgency? Urine frequency and color?"
4	Thirst/drink	"Thirsty? A lot or small sips? Hot or cold drinks?"
5	Energy	"Energy through the day — steady or dips? Tired even after resting?"
6	Head/face/body	"Headaches — where, what kind? Dizziness? Body aches?"
7	Chest/abdomen	"Chest tightness/fullness? Abdominal distension or pain? What brings it on/relieves it?"
8	Limbs	"Numbness, tingling, weakness, heaviness? One side or both?"
9	Sleep	"Trouble falling or staying asleep? Dream a lot? Wake rested?"

#	Category	Example Questions to Ask
10	Sweating	"More than usual? When — day, night, exertion? Where?"
11	Ears/eyes	"Hearing, ringing? Vision — blurry, dry, floaters?"
12	Cold/heat/fever	"Run colder/hotter than others? Fevers/chills? Cold hands/feet?"
13	Emotional	"How are you feeling emotionally? Anxiety, low mood, irritability, worry? Stressors right now?"
14	Sexual	"Changes in libido or anything uncomfortable?" — asked gently, following the conversation.
15	Women's	"Last period, cycle regular? Days, flow heavy/light/clotted? Pain, discharge?"
16	Children's	"Appetite, energy, sleep? Behavior/mood changes?" — asked to caregiver + direct observation.

✨ The classical 10 Questions (十问歌) — Zhang Jingyue's song

#	Classical Question	#	Classical Question
1	Cold and heat 寒热	6	Chest and abdomen 胸腹
2	Sweat 汗	7	Deafness/hearing 聋
3	Head and body 头身	8	Thirst 渴
4	Stool and urine 二便	9	Old disease 旧病
5	Food and drink 饮食	10	Cause 因



10 → 16, what actually changed

Maciocia didn't discard Zhang Jingyue's classical 10 — he split compound categories apart (Chest/Abdomen, Head/Body become distinct) and promoted implicit categories to full standalone items (Energy levels, Emotional, Sexual, Women's, Children's symptoms), then reordered so Pain leads and Chills/Fever confirms at the end. Same tradition, modernized packaging.

✨ Master Pain Table

Factor	Empty	Full	Cold	Heat
Pressure	Alleviated	Aggravated	—	—
Type	Dull, lingering	Sharp	Cramping	Burning
Temperature	—	—	Better w/ heat	Better w/ cold
Onset	Slow, gradual	Sudden	—	—
Rest/movement	Better w/ rest	Better w/ movement	Better w/ movement	Worse w/ movement

✨ Pain by Cause

Cause	Character	Location
Qi stagnation	Distension > pain, no fixed location	Epigastrium, abdomen

Cause	Character	Location
Blood stasis	Boring/stabbing, FIXED	Head, chest, epigastrium, Uterus
Cold	Cramping, better with heat	Epigastrium, Uterus, joints
Damp-Heat	Burning + fullness/heaviness	Forehead, epigastrium, Bladder, joints
External Wind	—	Occiput



Thirst Quick Reference

— Large cold drinks = Full-Heat. Small sips = Yin deficiency. No thirst = Cold. Thirst, no desire to drink = Damp-Heat.

✨ Maciocia's 8-Step Full Intake Procedure

- 1. Let the patient speak freely about the presenting problem
- 2. Ask specific questions to determine the pattern, establishing onset
- 3. Ask questions to exclude or confirm other patterns
- 4. Broadly follow the 16 questions
- 5. Ask about past diseases and operations
- 6. Look at the tongue, feel the pulse
- 7. Ask about family illnesses
- 8. Inquire about emotional/family/work life to find the cause



Maciocia's own caveat

— "What matters is the general PICTURE formed by the symptoms... it is only for didactic purposes that we list symptoms in isolation." Never diagnose off one isolated answer — always integrate the full clinical picture.



EAM310 • Palpation Reference

FCM Ch.25 • Abdomen, Chest, Skin, Apical Pulse

Week 8-9 • Jon Centeno • VUIM

✨ Abdominal Palpation

Finding	Indicates
Solid, resilient, elastic	Good Original Qi — NORMAL
Hard / painful on palpation	Full condition
Too soft / ache relieved by palpation	Empty condition
Masses that MOVE	Qi stagnation
Masses FIXED and hard	Blood stasis

✨ Chest Palpation

Finding	Indicates
Tender at Ren-17 (centre), light pressure	Heart-Blood stasis
Tender around centre	Excess condition of Lungs (often Phlegm)
Palpation RELIEVES discomfort	Deficiency of Heart or Lungs
Relief w/ light, discomfort w/ deep pressure	Combined Deficiency + Excess

✨ Apical Beat (Heart Apex / Xu Li)

Finding	Indicates
Clear, not hard, relatively slow	Normal
Feeble, no strength	Deficiency of Gathering Qi (Zong Qi)
Strong and hard	Excess condition Lungs/Heart
Discrepancy with radial pulse	Poor prognosis

Skin Temperature

- Cold limbs → Spleen + Stomach Yang deficiency
- Cold loins/lower back/feet → Kidney-Yang deficiency
- Cold lower abdomen → Spleen-Yang deficiency



EAM310 • Listening & Smelling Reference 🐱

FCM Ch.26 • Auscultation & Olfaction

Week 9 • Jon Centeno • VUIM

🔊 General Rule — Hearing

LOUD sound = Full pattern
WEAK sound = Empty pattern

👃 General Rule — Smelling

STRONG/FOUL = Heat
ABSENCE of smell = Cold

🌟 Five-Element Voice & Smell Correspondence

Element	Organ	Voice	Smell
Wood	Liver	Shouting	Rancid
Fire	Heart	Laughing	Scorched
Earth	Spleen	Singing	Fragrant/sweetish
Metal	Lung	Weeping	Rotten
Water	Kidney	Groaning	Putrid

🌟 Voice & Sound Quick Reference

Sign	Indicates
Sudden loss of voice	Invasion of exterior Wind-Heat
Gradual loss of voice	Lung-Qi or Lung-Yin deficiency
Dry cough	Lung-Yin deficiency
Reluctance to talk	Cold pattern or Lung-Qi deficiency
Excessive/incessant talking	Heat pattern

🔧 Hammer Companion — Pseudo-Arrhythmias

Before diagnosing Knotted/Hasty/Intermittent, re-check the pulse with the patient still and breathing calmly — many “irregular” pulses are pseudo-arrhythmias from movement, talking, or breath-holding.

Feel irregularity

→ Re-check still/calm

Still irregular = real

Resolves = pseudo



✨ Tongue + Pulse Combination Cheat Sheet

Pattern	Tongue	Pulse
Wind-Cold	Thin white coat	Floating, Tight
Wind-Heat	Thin yellow coat	Floating, Rapid
Full-Heat	Red, thick yellow coat	Rapid, Full
Empty-Heat	Red, NO coating	Rapid, Fine
Full-Cold	Pale, thick white coat	Deep, Full, Tight, Slow
Empty-Cold	Pale, thin white coat, wet	Deep, Weak, Slow
Blood stasis	Purple / purple spots	Choppy, Wiry, or Firm
Liver-Yang rising	Red sides	Wiry
Phlegm/Dampness	Swollen, greasy coat	Slippery

✨ Six-Step Pattern Differentiation Walkthrough

- **1. Exterior or Interior?** — aversion to cold + fever together = Exterior
- **2. Cold or Heat?** — thirst, pulse rate, tongue color
- **3. Deficiency or Excess?** — pain response to pressure, coat thickness
- **4. Check for False Phenomena** — True Heat/False Cold? True Cold/False Heat?
- **5. Qi/Blood/Body Fluid layer** — which substance is disturbed?
- **6. Confirm with Tongue + Pulse** — do they agree? If not, why?



Maciocia Companion Ch.8 — Integration Principles

Pulse changes quickly (minutes-hours) — affected by emotion, exertion, meals. Tongue changes slowly (days-weeks) — more stable. When they disagree, the tongue usually reflects the more reliable CHRONIC pattern, while the pulse may be catching something more ACUTE layered on top.



EAM310 • Companion Book References

Hammer & Bilton (Pulse) • Maciocia (Tongue)

Weeks 3, 4, 6, 9, 10 • Jon Centeno • VUIM

✨ Pulse Companion — Handbook of Contemporary Chinese Pulse Diagnosis (Hammer & Bilton)

Hammer Axis	Closest FCM Equivalent	What's New
Rate (Ch.7)	Slow / Rapid	Age-adjusted ranges; rate variation over time as its own sign
Rhythm (Ch.6)	Knotted / Hasty / Intermittent	Pseudo-arrhythmia concept
Volume (Ch.8)	Empty / Full	Independent measurable dimension
Depth (Ch.9)	Floating / Deep	Granular superficial/submerged sub-classification



The One Concept You MUST Know — Pseudo-Arrhythmias

An irregularity that mimics a true Knotted/Hasty/Intermittent pulse but stems from a benign cause (patient moving, talking, breath-holding, normal sinus arrhythmia). Before diagnosing a real arrhythmia: re-check with the patient still and breathing calmly across multiple cycles.

✨ Tongue Companion — Tongue Diagnosis in Chinese Medicine, 3rd ed. (Maciocia)

Site	With Coating	Without Coating
Tip	Heart-Fire	Heart Empty-Heat
Sides	Liver-Fire / GB-Heat	Liver-Yin def. with Empty-Heat
Center	Stomach-Heat (Full)	Stomach Empty-Heat (Yin def.)
Root	Heat in the Lower Burner (red spots)	



Ch.8 — Final Exam's Best Friend

Covers exactly what the Final tests: how tongue integrates with pulse and symptoms, when tongue overrides conflicting signs, and tongue findings in prognosis.

Only each companion's confirmed table of contents is in our source files, not full body text. Content here uses each book's organizational framework cross-referenced against the fully-loaded FCM chapters. Bring physical pages for exact quotes. 🎀